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Dubai sees 90% drop in traffic fatalities

DUBAI
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Dubai saw a 90 per cent drop in road fatalities and traffic accidents between 2007 and 2024, according to the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA).
Mattar Al Tayar, Director-General and Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors at RTA, while praising the ongoing strategic partnership with Dubai Police, said, "Our joint work continues to move us closer to the vision of 'Zero Fatalities,' aligning with Dubai's goal of becoming a global benchmark in traffic safety."

Lieutenant General Abdullah Khalifa Al Marri, Commander-in-Chief of Dubai Police, said: "Over 90 per cent reduction in road fatalities and incidents has been achieved since 2007. Awareness campaigns played a crucial role, engaging all segments of society."
Meanwhile, a staggering 648,631 violations of mobile phone use while driving were recorded in 2024, according to the Ministry of Interior.

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UAE, SYRIA TO STRENGTHEN BILATERAL TIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan held talks yesterday with Ahmad Al Sharaa, President of Syria, on the fraternal relations between the two countries and ways to strengthen cooperation for the benefit of both peoples. The meeting was held at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi, where Shaikh Mohammad wished the Syrian leader success in fulfilling the people's hopes for development, security and stability.

WAM

4 dead in Sharjah high-rise blaze

SEVERAL RESIDENTS SUSTAIN INJURIES OR SUFFER FROM SMOKE INHALATION

SHARJAH
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Four men died and several others were injured after a fire broke out in a residential high-rise in Sharjah's Al Nahda area yesterday, authorities confirmed.

The victims, of African origin, lost their lives after jumping from the building in a desperate attempt to escape.

The blaze is believed to have started on the 42nd floor of the 51-storey tower, which includes 42 floors of apartments and nine levels of parking. The floor is sealed off to residents.

Despite the swift response from emergency services, some residents suffered smoke inhalation and injuries. A total of 148 residents were safely evacuated.

Authorities confirmed that the entire building was cleared in record time. Six people are being treated in hospital. Other people received onsite care.

An Egyptian man living on the 21st floor told *Gulf News* that they never heard a fire alarm. "We left our apartment quickly and saw smoke in the corridor," he said. "We rushed down the stairs. When we reached the ground floor, we saw firefighters and emergency teams at the scene. They helped us stay safe."

Immediate support

The Sharjah Social Services Department provided immediate support on-site, distributing water, juice, and sandwiches to the affected residents.

Another resident said: "There were no flames — just thick smoke. Firefighters a helped



The 51-storey residential tower in Al Nahda.

us down the stairs and used ladders to evacuate others and check for anyone trapped."

Maintenance work

Scaffolding and ropes had been installed on the exterior of the building for maintenance work.



Scan the QR code for more updates on the residential tower fire

One resident reportedly used the ropes to descend and survived. Others tried to follow, but lost their grip and fell. One victim landed on the scaffolding, which collapsed under his weight.

Residents from the third floor shared a harrowing account: "We saw an African man lying motionless on the ground. He had apparently jumped from the top of the building and died."

Authorities are investigating the cause of the fire and are urging all residential buildings to ensure that fire alarm systems are fully functional and regularly maintained.

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